

Economic Modernization

During this period -> Known as Meiji Restoration -> Japan implemented many policies to modernize itself and catch up with the west.

Japan -> did not want a repeat of its encounter with US or to be in same position as china.

1871 -> Meiji government:

- sent academic and other officials to united states and Europe to learn how the western nations ran their governments, economies and armed forces.*
1. Introduced policies -> based on principle of Fukoku Kyohei (Enrich the country, strengthen the army) -> to strengthen Japans economic foundations which helped it to build a strong military to defend against foreign invaders.
 2. Industrialized its economy. With use of western technology -> Japans production increased rapidly. infrastructure -> such as banking system and railroads were set up to support Japans production. Powerful and large corporations called zaibatsu -> also established.
 3. Japan began to open up. Engaged in foreign trade and started to export goods to the rest of the world.
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